Statement

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Statement in the matter of R v Vida Reid

Name	Karen Ruth Canalija Marasigan
Occupation	Head of Compliance
Address	Known to National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS)
Date	17 October 2022

STATES:

1. This statement made by me accurately sets out the evidence that I would be prepared, if necessary, to give in court as a witness.

2. My full name is Karen Ruth Canalija Marasigan.

3. I am 39 years old.

4. I am the Head of Compliance for the company Zettai Pty Ltd, ABN 21637637131 trading as Assist Plan Managers.

5. I have held this position since December 2021. Prior to this, I held the position of accounts clerk from February 2021 to December 2021. We currently have no fixed office location and work remotely.

6. In my role as Head of Compliance, my key duties include ensuring that the Accounts Team process invoices in compliance with the price guide and NDIA requirements, investigating and responding to compliance-related issues raised by the team.

7. In the course of a normal day my section receives service provider invoices, validates the invoices through our systems, forwards the claim to the National Disability

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Insurance Agency (NDIA) for payment and receives funds for successful claims to remit to providers.

8. I am familiar with the computer systems used by the business, and I have access to the electronic and hard copy records held by the business.

9. On 10 March 2020 Assist Plan Managers was registered as a Plan Management service provider with the National Disability Insurance Scheme Commission (NDIS Commission) and was allocated the provider number 4050063455.

10. Assist Plan Managers is registered as an NDIS Plan Manager, which enables us to offer plan management services to National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS) participants.

11. As a Plan Manager, Assist Plan Managers act as a financial intermediary and undertake a series of administrative tasks to process financial transactions on the participant's behalf.

12. When we are engaged by the NDIS Participant or their Plan Nominee, we establish their plan details and enter those details into our system.

13. We do not always have access to a Participant's NDIS plan but generally speaking, at a minimum, we will have access to the budget categories that have been allocated in the Participant's NDIS plan and the total funds allocated to be plan managed for those categories.

14. If requested, we then support the participant in exercising their choice and control over the types of goods and services to be purchased using those approved funds as set out in the Pricing Arrangements and Price Limits. We evaluate the claims for payment against the participant plan and NDIS Price Arrangements and Price Limits requirements.

15. A claim is made by a participant or a provider forwarding an invoice, by email to invoices@assistplanmanagers.com.au. That email is then picked up by one of our team

and then reviewed, processing the claims date and details against the participant's details and the NDIS Price Arrangements and Price Limits and any other conditions.

16. Assist Plan Managers can receive hundreds of such emails with invoices attached per day. We archive all of these emails following the company' procedures. The attached invoices are downloaded and stored per individual participant.

17. It is Assist Plan Managers practice to ensure that the Australian Business Numbers that appear on invoices are recorded against the provider at the time a record for the provider is established in the system.

18. All claims processed by Assist Plan Managers are batched for the day and are submitted to the NDIA as a bulk upload. However, in instances where we can't do bulk upload, we will do a single entry. After the upload, we can download a summary of the uploaded invoices and check what has been paid and what hasn't. The following working day we will receive the funds from the NDIS for disbursement to the Service Providers.

19. On the occasions where an invoice has not been paid due to error, we will cancel the invoice on CareView and then investigate further.

20. I know of Vida as the Founding Executive Director of the company Forward Focused Group.

21. I know of the companies Forward Focused Group and The Hive but only as providers with Assist Plan Managers.

22. I have met Vida on one occasion. This was in January 2022. We organised a meeting with her as there were recurring issues with Forward Focused Group's invoices. The common errors were 1.) some line items in newly submitted invoices were already claimed in previous invoices; 2.) invoices with item codes not matching with service booking item codes, and 3.) invoices rejected by client due to services not provided. During this meeting, Vida and her team appeared willing to cooperate and fix the issues and stated that there was a lack of training, and they are still learning.

23. Forward Focused Group and The Hive's bank account details were created on Assist Plan Manager's system.

24. There have been changes to these bank accounts for The Hive and Forward Focused Group since they were created.

25. The email addresses held on Assist Plan Managers system for Forward Focused Group and The Hive are accounts@ffg.net.au and accounts@hybridhive.com.au

NDIS Participant Meghan Goodwin

26. On reviewing the electronic records maintained by Assist Plan Managers, I can state the following for the participant Meghan Goodwin (GOODWIN):

    a. Assist Plan Managers were engaged as the Plan Manager for GOODWIN on 1 December 2021. We provided Plan Management services up to 9 August 2022.

    b. GOODWIN's NDIS number is 431576199

    c. GOODWIN's date of birth is 14 May 1990.

    d. There was a Service Agreement in place between Assist Plan Managers and Meghan Goodwin.

    e. To my knowledge there were service agreements between Forward Focused Group and GOODWIN. Assist Plan Managers were provided with service agreement electronically for GOODWIN from Forward Focused Group.

    f. Claims for payment for GOODWIN from Forward Focused Group and The Hive were received by Assist Plan Managers as invoices created by Forward Focus Group and The Hive as a ".PDF" file attached to an email sent to invoices@assistplanmanagers.com.au by their automated system Xero.

    g. It is my understanding that the accounts teams from The Hive and Forward Focus Group would create these invoices and send them through Xero.

h. Regarding GOODWIN and The Hive, The Accounts Team of Assist Plan Managers would most commonly receive email communication from The Hive employee Virginie Fannie Duloo in relation to invoices and any payment issues.

i. Regarding GOODWIN and Forward Focused Group, The Accounts Team of Assist Plan Managers would most commonly receive email communication from Forward Focused Group employees Danica Hall and Ashleigh Oleksiuk in relation to invoices and any payment issues.

j. The emails from Forward Focused Group with invoices attached are held with Assist Plan Managers.

k. The emails from The Hive with invoices attached are listed in **ANNEXURE A.**

l. Forward Focused Group submitted claims for payment (invoices) to Assist Plan Managers for the participant GOODWIN. Those invoices are listed in **ANNEXURE B.**

m. The Hive submitted claims for payment (invoices) to Assist Plan Managers for the participant GOODWIN. Those invoices are listed in **ANNEXURE C.**

n. Assist Plan Managers batched these invoices with others from Forward Focus Group and The Hive at the time and submitted them to the NDIA as a bulk upload. After this, to see if all the line items are successful, Assist Plan Managers download a file from the portal and check and filter the line items with errors and correct any errors. All the uploads with successful line items will be paid from the NDIA the following day with funds being received into Assist Plan Managers bank account.

o. Assist Plan Managers then matched the claimed invoices with the successful and part claims. Funds were then disbursed to the bank account nominated by FORWARD FOCUS GROUP and THE HIVE when the account was first set up with Assist Plan Managers.

p. Payments to The Hive regarding GOODWIN, were disbursed to BSB 036 022 and Account Number 536 804 in the name of Hybrid Hive Pty Ltd. The initial account for The Hive for payments for GOODWIN was BSB 016 253 and Account Number 154 173 449. The Hive notified Assist Plan Managers of a change to bank account details

on 18 May 2022. The change was made on Assist Plan Manager's system. This was after Assist Plan Managers received an email from Chief Financial Officer Rejaul Alam on 17 May 2022, requesting a change in bank account details.

q. Payments to Forward Focused Group regarding GOODWIN were disbursed to BSB 036 032 and Account number 736 973 in the name of Forward Focus Group Pty Ltd. The initial account for Forward Focus Group for payments for GOODWIN was BSB 016 253 and Account number 152 003 884. Forward Focus Group changed bank accounts on 18 May 2022 on the Assist Plan Managers System. This was after Assist Plan Managers received an email from Chief Financial Officer Rejaul Alam on 17 May 2022, requesting a change in bank account details.

r. When funds were disbursed to these accounts, remittance advice notices were also sent to the email address accounts@ffg.net.au advising of the payments and accounts@hybridhive.com.au.

s. Remittance advices could be for a single payment for a single participant or could be for multiple payments for multiple participants.

t. When the funds were paid to the bank account, they correlate to the remittance notices.

u. The email sending the remittance advice was retained.

v. Assist Plan Managers submitted remittance advices to Forward Focus Group for the participant GOODWIN. Those remittance advices are listed in **ANNEXURE D.**

w. Assist Plan Managers submitted remittance advices to The Hive for the participant GOODWIN. Those remittance advices are listed in **ANNEXURE E**.

NDIS Participant Sarah Jane Clulow

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27. On reviewing the electronic records maintained by Assist Plan Managers, I can state the following regarding the participant Sarah Jane Clulow (CLULOW):

a) Assist Plan Managers were engaged as the plan manager for CLULOW on 16 November 2021 and continue in that capacity.

b) CLULOW's NDIS number is 430838840.

c) CLULOW's date of birth is 16 May 1987.

d) There is a Service Agreement in place between Assist Plan Managers and CLULOW.

e) To my knowledge there were Service Agreements between Forward Focus Group, CLULOW. Assist Plan Managers were provided with Service Agreements electronically for CLULOW from Forward Focus Group.

f) Claims for payment for CLULOW from Forward Focused Group were received by Assist Plan Managers as invoices created by Forward Focus Group as a ".PDF" file attached to an email sent to invoices@assistplanmanagers.com.au by their automated system Xero.

g) It is my understanding that the accounts teams from Forward Focus Group would create these invoices and send them through Xero.

h) Regarding CLULOW and Forward Focus Group, the Accounts Team of Assist Plan Managers would most commonly receive email communication from Forward Focus Group employees Danica Hall and Ashleigh Oleksiuk in relation to invoices and any payment issues.

i) The emails from Forward Focused Group with invoices are held with Assist Plan Managers.

j) Forward Focused Group submitted claims for payment (invoices) to Assist Plan Managers for the participant. Those invoices are listed in **ANNEXURE F.**

k) Assist Plan Managers batch these invoices with others from Forward Focus Group and The Hive at the time and submit them to the NDIA as a bulk upload. After this to see if all the line items are successful, Assist Plan Managers download a file from the

portal and check and filter the line items with errors and correct any errors. All the uploads with successful line items will be paid from the NDIA the following day with funds being received into Assist Plan Managers bank account.

l) Assist Plan Managers then matched the claimed invoices with the successful and part claims proceeding to settlement. Funds were then disbursed to the bank account nominated by FORWARD FOCUS GROUP and The Hive when the account was first set up with Assist Plan Managers.

m) Payments to The Hive regarding CLULOW, were disbursed to BSB 036 022 and Account Number 536 804 in the name of Hybrid Hive Pty Ltd. The initial account for The Hive for payments for CLULOW was BSB 016 253 and Account Number 154 173 449. The Hive changed bank accounts on 18 May 2022 on Assist Plan Managers system. This was after Assist Plan Managers received an email from Chief Financial Officer Rejaul Alam on 17 May 2022, requesting a change in bank account details.

n) Payments to Forward Focused Group regarding CLULOW were disbursed to BSB 036 032 and Account number 736 973 in the name of Forward Focus Group Pty Ltd. The initial account for Forward Focus Group for payments for CLULOW was BSB 016 253 and Account number 152 003 884. Forward Focus Group changed bank accounts on 18 May 2022 on Assist Plan Managers System received an email from Chief Financial Officer Rejaul Alam on 17 May 2022, requesting a change in bank account details.

o) When funds were disbursed to this account, a remittance advice notice was also sent to the email address accounts@ffg.net.au advising of the payment and accounts@hybridhive.com.au.

p) Remittance advices could be for a single payment for a single participant or could be for multiple payments for multiple participants.

q) When the funds were paid to the bank account, they correlate to the remittance notices.

r) The email sending the remittance advice was retained.

s) Assist Plan Managers submitted remittance advices to Forward Focus Group for the participant CLULOW. Those remittance advices are listed in **ANNEXURE G.**

ANNEXURE A –EMAILS RECEIEVD FROM THE HIVE WITH INVOICES ATTACHED FOR PARTICIPANT MEGHAN GOODWIN

Email address	Invoice Number	Date sent
on behalf of admin Hive <messaging-service@post.xero.com	0162	21 January 2022
on behalf of admin Hive <messaging-service@post.xero.com	0161	21 January 2022
on behalf of admin Hive <messaging-service@post.xero.com	0143	21 January 2022
on behalf of admin Hive <messaging-service@post.xero.com	0163	21 January 2022
on behalf of admin Hive <messaging-service@post.xero.com	0159	21 January 2022
on behalf of admin Hive <messaging-service@post.xero.com	0150	21 January 2022
on behalf of admin Hive <messaging-service@post.xero.com	0160	21 January 2022
on behalf of Accounts Hive <messaging-service@post.xero.com>	0177	27 January 2022
on behalf of Accounts Hive <messaging-service@post.xero.com>	0323	28 February 2022
on behalf of Accounts Hive <messaging-service@post.xero.com>	0286	28 February 2022
Blesson Varghese <messaging-service@post.xero.com>	0474	8 April 2022

ANNEXURE B – INVOICES SUBMITTED BY FORWARD FOCUSED GROUP FOR PARTICIPANT MEGHAN GOODWIN

Invoice Number	Date
NDIS 861-1	13 December 2021
INV 0485	7 December 2021
NDIS 1031-1	10 January 2022
NDIS 1084-1	14 January 2022
NDIS 1263-1	24 February 2022
NDIS 1284-1	28 February 2022
NDIS 1297-1	3 March 2022
NDIS 1314-1	9 March 2022
NDIS 1398-1	24 March 2022
NDIS 1488-1	8 April 2022

ANNEXURE C – INVOICES SUBMITTED BY THE HIVE FOR PARTICIPANT MEGHAN GOODWIN

Invoice Number	Date
INV 0162	13 January 2022
INV 0161	6 January 2022
INV 0143	9 December 2021
INV 0163	20 January 2022
INV 0159	23 December 2021
INV 0150	16 December 2021
INV 0160	30 December 2021
INV 0177	27 January 2022
INV 0323	25 February 2022
INV 0286	11 February 2022
INV 0474	8 April 2022

ANNEXURE D – REMITTANCE NOTICES SENT TO FORWARD FOCUSED GROUP FOR PARTICIPANT MEGHAN GOODWIN

Remittance Number	Invoice Number	Payment Date
27	861-1	6 January 2022
27	0485	7 January 2022
26	1031-1	13 January 2022
26	1084-1	18 January 2022
25	1263-1	1 March 2022
24	1284-1	3 March 2022
24	1297-1	8 March 2022
24	1314-1	15 March 2022
22	1398-1	29 March 2022
20	14888-1	21 April 2022

ANNEXURE E – REMITTANCE NOTICES SENT TO THE HIVE FOR PARTICIPANT MEGHAN GOODWIN

Remittance Number	Invoice Numbers	Payment Date
8	0162; 0161; 0143; 0163; 0159; 0150; 0160	26 January 2022
8	0177	29 January 2022
8	0323; 0286	3 March 2022
5	0474	12 May 2022

ANNEXURE F – INVOICES SUBMITTED BY THE HIVE FOR PARTICIPANT SARAH-JANE CLULOW

Invoice Number	Date
INV-0850	3/1/2022
INV-0457	18/11/2021
NDIS-789-1	29/11/2021
INV-0942	04/04/2022
NDIS-1227-1	17/02/2022
NDIS-1270-1	24/02/2022

INV-0493	10/12/2021
INV-0657	31/01/2022
INV-0657 (2)	31/01/2022
INV-0673	02/02/2022
INV-0657	31/01/2022
INV-789-1	29/11/2021
INV-0848	20/12/2021
INV-0849	27/12/2021
INV-0850	03/01/2022
INV-0851	10/01/2022
INV-0865	14/02/2022
INV-0869	14/03/2022
INV-0895	21/03/2022
INV-0924	28/03/2022
INV-0942	04/04/2022
INV-0967	11/04/2022
INV-0983	12/042022
INV-0986	13/04/2022
INV-1007	18/04/2022
INV-1011	19/04/2022
NDIS-965-1	22/12/2021
NDIS-999-1	29/12/2021
NDIS-1009-1	29/12/2021
NDIS-1013-1	04/01/2022
NDIS-1147-1	31/01/2022
NDIS-1175-1	10/02/2022

NDIS-1281-1	28/02/2022
NDIS-1303-1	03/03/2022
NDIS-1322-1	10/03/2022
NDIS-789-1	29/11/2021

ANNEXURE G – REMIITTANCES SUBMITTED BY ASSIST PLAN MANAGERS TO FORWARD FOCUS GROUP FOR PARTICIPANT SARAH-JANE CLULOW

Remittance Number	Invoice Number	Payment Date
12	INV-1254	18/06/2022
19	INV-0983	23/04/2022
20	INV-0967	14/04/2022
20	INV-0986	22/04/2022
21	INV-0942	9/04/2022
22	INV-0895	29/03/2022
22	INV-0924	2/04/2022
23	INV-0848	19/03/2022
23	INV-0849	19/03/2022
23	INV-0850	19/03/2022
23	INV-0851	19/03/2022
23	INV-0865	19/03/2022
23	INV-0869	19/03/2022
24	INV-0848	19/03/2022
24	INV-0849	19/03/2022
24	INV-0850	19/03/2022

24	INV-0851	19/03/2022
24	INV-0865	19/03/2022
24	NDIS-1281-1	4/03/2022
24	NDIS-1303-1	8/03/2022
25	INV-0657	2/02/2022
25	INV-0673	4/02/2022
25	NDIS-1175-1	12/02/2022
20	INV-1007	22/04/2022
20	INV-1011	21/04/2022
24	NDIS-1322-1	16/03/2022
24	INV-0869	19/03/2022
25	NDIS-1227-1	22/02/2022
25	NDIS-1270-1	26/02/2022
26	NDIS-1147-1	2/02/2022
27	NDIS-965-1	24/12/2021
27	NDIS-999-1	31/12/2021
27	NDIS-1009-1	31/12/2021
27	NDIS-1013-1	8/01/2022
28	INV-0457	25/11/2021
28	NDIS-789-1	2/12/2021
28	INV-0493	15/12/2021

28. I can produce copies of the bank account statements of Assist Plan Managers to confirm the dates monies were received from the NDIS as a result of the lodging of claims and the subsequent transfer of funds by Assist Plan Managers to Forward Focus Group and The Hive's bank accounts if required. I wish to note though that our bank statements show bulk amounts and the details of the transferred payments are shown in ABA file.

29. I have provided NDIA Investigator Harsley the emails, invoices and remittances in relation to NDIS Participants Meagan Goodwin and Sarah-Jane Clulow which is contained within the Annexures. I did not prepare the Annexures.

This statement is true to the best of my knowledge and belief. I have made this statement knowing that, if it is tendered in evidence, I will be guilty of a crime if I have wilfully included in the statement anything that I know to be false or that I do not believe is true.

Signature _____
Karen Ruth Canalija Marasigan

Statement taken and signature witnessed by me about 3.43pm on 17 October 2022 at CANNINGVALE in Western Australia.

Signature _____
Sian Harsley
NDIS Investigator